

Topic 4: AI for Email and Professional Communication

4.1 Types of Email AI Excels At

- Cold outreach: personalised first-contact emails at scale
- Follow-ups: polite, persistent follow-up after no reply
- Proposals and pitches: structured, benefit-focused value propositions
- Difficult messages: sensitive feedback, apologies, or declining requests with care
- Internal updates: status reports, team announcements, change communications
- Customer lifecycle: onboarding emails, check-ins, and renewal conversations

4.2 Writing the Email Prompt

- Include: who you are, who the recipient is, your relationship, the purpose, the key message, and the desired action
- Specify tone: professional, warm, urgent, apologetic, confident, low-pressure
- Specify length: 'under 80 words' for a quick follow-up; 'around 200 words' for a detailed proposal
- Add constraints: 'do not mention our pricing yet', 'do not sound desperate', 'avoid the phrase circle back'

Email prompt example:

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'Write a follow-up email to a potential B2B client.  
We met at a conference last week; they showed interest in our  
project management tool but have not replied to my first email  
sent 5 days ago.  
Goal: schedule a 20-minute demo call.  
Tone: warm, confident, low-pressure.  
Length: under 80 words.  
Include two specific time options for the call.'
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4.3 Responding to Difficult Emails

- Angry customer: 'Draft a response that acknowledges their frustration, apologises, and offers a resolution: [paste complaint]'
- Declining a request: 'Write a polite refusal to this request without damaging the relationship: [paste request]'
- Negotiation counter-offer: 'Draft a counter-proposal that holds our position but shows flexibility on the timeline'

- Ambiguous request: 'Draft a reply asking for clarification without sounding obstructive or passive-aggressive'
- Tip: always read the AI draft before sending -- it cannot know relationship history or unspoken context

4.4 Email Sequences

- Onboarding sequence: 'Write a 5-email sequence for new software users, spaced over 2 weeks'
 - Cold outreach sequence: 'Write a 4-email sequence: intro, value prop, social proof, and a final gentle close'
 - Re-engagement: 'Write an email to subscribers who have not opened in 90 days'
 - Generate the full sequence in one prompt to maintain consistent voice and logical progression across all emails
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